



PROGRESS REPORT

Botswana: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 107 systems and instruments tracked

Of 107 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 46 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 18 did not, 32 carry no stated baseline, and 11 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 174 sources for this place in the window — 38 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 136 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The window's real movement is legislative. The [Digital Services Act](#) went from passed-but-not-in-force to in force on 21 November 2025; the [Cybersecurity Act 2025](#) went from a Bill to made and gazetted, and is still not in force; and the [Remote Service VAT Act](#) took effect on 1 June 2026 at 14% on non-resident digital services. The data-protection commission moved from three contract officers with no premises to a commissioner in post enforcing against a government directorate.

Money moved the other way. Three digital development lines were cut for FY2026/27 — the [communications ministry ICT project](#) from P369,079,545 to P251,000,000, [research and development](#) from P477,403,718 to P213,700,000, and [basic education computerisation](#) from P270,000,000 to P253,000,000 — against FY2025/26 outturns of 38.7%, 9.0% and zero respectively.

Two operating positions worsened: [identity-card production](#) and the [listed operator's profit](#), down 45% to P146.2m.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National E-Waste Management Strategy	Did not exist	Strategy launched and an inter-agency memorandum signed; no targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates published	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Services Authority	Under consideration and publicly contested as duplicative (2025-08-18)	Still announced only; nothing on record being built at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
ICT Roadmap 2030	BASELINE NOT HELD	A blueprint targeting 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit ICT share of GDP; its named priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume	Baseline not held

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity Act 2025	Not enacted; a Bill only (2025-08)	Made and gazetted, not in force at 2026-08-06, the stated April 2026 commencement having passed	ADVANCED, THE STATED APRIL 2026 COMMENCEMENT NOT ON RECORD
Digital Services Act	Passed 2024, not in force; a standalone services agency publicly contested (2025-08-18)	In force; the compliance clock runs to November 2027	ADVANCED
Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026	Did not exist	In operation; scope extended to money or value transfer services, fit-and-proper reaching beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Authority	Did not exist (2025-08)	Created in law with a board, chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate; not established, and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates	ADVANCED
Remote Service VAT Act	Announced, not in effect; the tax system described as built for tangible goods (2026-03-23)	In effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year	ADVANCED
Virtual Asset Act 2022 and provider licensing	Act in force, crypto not legal tender (2025-07)	Act in force; the regional assessor still records provider-oversight shortcomings (2026-02)	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate	Did not exist	Portal suspended; a privacy notice published 2026-07-06, an impact assessment completed 2026-07-13, multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan added; no reopening date	ADVANCED
Information and Data Protection Commission	Three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner (2025-07-29)	A commissioner in post, enforcing against non-bank financial institutions in February 2026 and against a government directorate in July 2026	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act No. 18 of 2024	In force, regulator not yet operational (2025-07-29)	In force; first published enforcement against a government body, 2026-07-17	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Botswana-Namibia ICT memorandum of understanding	No bilateral ICT memorandum on file (2025-08)	Signed at Kasane on 7 August 2026 between the two ICT ministries, with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development; the accompanying disclosure costs the Trans-Kalahari Corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites, and records NAM-CSIRT and BW-CIRT deepening cybersecurity cooperation. No term, funding or data-governance provision is published	ADVANCED
Botswana-South Africa innovation memorandum	Did not exist	Signed between the two countries' innovation agencies on cross-border innovation and technology commercialisation	ADVANCED
SADC One Network Area roaming	Botswana-Namibia reduced roaming rates only (2024-08)	Six SADC states; roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, Botswana-Zambia data roaming down by up to 94%, incoming SMS free across participants	ADVANCED
SADC regional internet exchange host bid	BASELINE NOT HELD	Shortlisted; no award decision on record in the eight months to 2026-08-06	Baseline not held

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ITU Radio Regulations Board candidature	BASELINE NOT HELD	A campaign under way with member-state lobbying; the election for the 2027-2030 term has not been held	Baseline not held

Three statutes changed state in the window. The [Digital Services Act](#) came into force with a compliance clock to November 2027; the [Cybersecurity Act 2025](#) was assented and gazetted and has not commenced, the stated April 2026 date having passed; and the [Electronic Payment Services \(Amendment\) Regulations 2026](#) came into operation, extending scope to money or value transfer services and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years. The [Remote Service VAT Act](#) moved from announced to in effect against a stated collection target of about P450m a year.

The institutions those statutes create did not follow. The [National Cybersecurity Authority](#) went from not existing to created in law with a board, a chief executive and a licensing power – and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates; the [Digital Services Authority](#) is where it was, announced and contested.

The exception is the data-protection commission, which went from [three contract officers with no premises, published address, website or deputy commissioner](#) to a commissioner in post enforcing against non-bank financial institutions and then against a government directorate. Regionally, roaming went from [Botswana-Namibia reduced rates only](#) to [six SADC states, with cuts of between 10% and 98.6%](#).

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Basic education ministry computerisation	P270,000,000 appropriated (FY2025/26), revised to P38,819,833, outturn PO	P253,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)	REGRESSED
Communications ministry ICT project	P369,079,545 appropriated (FY2025/26), outturn P142,712,599 at 38.7%	P251,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Communications ministry research and development project	P477,403,718 appropriated (FY2025/26), outturn P42,771,544 at 9.0%	P213,700,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)	REGRESSED
Higher education ministry computerisation	P3,950,000 appropriated (FY2025/26), fully spent	P16,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)	ADVANCED
Shared Digital Services department recurrent vote	P594,362,280 appropriated (FY2025/26)	P587,310,850 appropriated (FY2026/27)	NO CHANGE
Revenue service modernisation line	BASELINE NOT HELD	P4.13bn proposed for electronic invoicing, digital taxation and border infrastructure	<i>Baseline not held</i>

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Orange Botswana and special economic zones memorandum	Did not exist	A framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity in special economic zones; no value stated	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Botswana Tech Fund	Did not exist	A GBP 50m target with GBP 10m committed and a GBP 5m first close; tickets GBP 25,000 to 100,000 for the accelerator and GBP 0.5m to 2m for growth	ADVANCED
Scalar Botswana Innovation Program	Did not exist	A twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups, routed to a US\$150m decarbonisation fund	ADVANCED

The budget is where this window's clearest deltas sit, and four of five run down. Against FY2025/26 appropriations, FY2026/27 gives the **communications ministry ICT project P251,000,000** rather than **P369,079,545** — a third consecutive cut from **P736.6m** in FY2024/25 — **research and development P213,700,000** rather than **P477,403,718**, and **basic education computerisation P253,000,000** rather than **P270,000,000** on a prior-year outturn of **P0**. The **largest recurrent line is flat at P587,310,850**. Only higher education computerisation rose, from **P3,950,000** fully spent to **P16,000,000**.

Private capital appeared where public capital withdrew. A **technology fund reached a GBP 5m first close** against a **GBP 50m target, with GBP 10m committed**; a **twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups launched**, routed to a **US\$150m decarbonisation fund** with no Botswana-specific allocation stated; and a **memorandum on connectivity in special economic zones** was signed with no value.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
MTC Namibia and BoFiNet cross-border fibre memorandum	No agreement on file (2025-08)	Delivered on its first leg: MTC has completed the Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link, now interconnecting with BoFiNet at Charles Hill, which the two sides describe as the first direct cross-border fibre link between the operators. The remaining 4G gaps along the Trans-Kalahari Corridor are costed at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Powertel-Paratus fibre corridor	Public-private agreement signed June 2025, no route carrying traffic	Phase 1 live at 800Gbps equipped on equipment rated over 10Tbps; phase 2 Bulawayo-Livingstone due September 2026	ADVANCED
BoFiNet internet gateway upgrade	P100m upgrade complete: metro networks replaced in Gaborone and Francistown, London and Johannesburg exchange equipment upgraded (2025-04-16)	Unchanged; no further gateway investment on file at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
BoFiNet Local Access Projects 2025/26	Baseline not held	Completed at P43m, extending fibre to three villages and connecting 191 customers with 210 construction jobs created, by an operator reporting P376m revenue, 99.7% service availability across the national fibre backbone and status as one of only five profitable state-owned enterprises operating without government subvention	BASELINE NOT HELD
BTC rural satellite connectivity programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	61 rural villages connected — schools, clinics and community centres — with 105 areas in process; no update on file since	Baseline not held
Internet penetration	BASELINE NOT HELD	2.09m users, 81.4% penetration (end-2025)	Baseline not held
National fibre network length	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia	Baseline not held
Village Connectivity Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	Running; no site count, target, budget or completion date published	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Data-localisation amendment to the Data Protection Act	No localisation amendment proposed on file (2025-08)	A stated intention to compel businesses to store data in Botswana; no bill, draft or date on file at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Digital Delta Data Centre	Built but not certified and not launched (2025-08)	In operation, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, state-owned through BoFiNet, offering storage, hosting and exchange	ADVANCED
Government migration to Digital Delta	A stated intention to migrate services held at the shared digital services department (2025-11-25)	Critical government services migrated; no confirmation on file that the mid-2026 initial phase completed	ADVANCED
Kala Data Centre	First module delivered and under commissioning, generators en route, no revenue (2025-09-26)	Fully commissioned; revenue described by the company as modest and at proof-of-concept scale; designed for up to 1MW, expansion subject to funding	ADVANCED
Palapye solar data-centre campus	No agreement on file (2025-08)	Memorandum only, targeted at hyperscale and AI compute; no capacity, cost, site approval or timeline, and nothing on file since October 2025	ADVANCED

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Kala hybrid gas and solar generation	Renewables named for future phases only (2025-09-26)	On-site gas-fired generation supplemented by solar, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review	ADVANCED
Lesedi 5MW solar development	No solar development on file (2025-08)	An initial 5MW assessed; no capital cost, approval or date	ADVANCED
Palapye 250MW solar and storage	Not on file (2025-08)	250MW solar with a foreseen 100-400MW battery storage system; nothing on file since October 2025	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Lesedi gas gathering network extension	BASELINE NOT HELD	An extension to connect a further production well, subject to funding; it gates the data centre's capacity expansion	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
International internet traffic	Just over 100Gbps (2025-02), up from under 8Gbps (2015)	Unchanged; no later figure published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Liquid Secure360	Not offered in Botswana (2025-08)	An integrated security framework and cloud services available to Botswana customers; no customer, revenue or capacity figures	ADVANCED
National Cyber Drill	No national cyber drill on file (2025-08)	A four-day 2026 drill held; the base separately records an inaugural drill in the same season	ADVANCED
Cybercrime and Computer Related Crimes Act 2018	In force (2025-08)	Still the operative cybercrime statute; its repeal is enacted but not commenced at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Suspected digital fraud rate	BASELINE NOT HELD	0.9% of consumer transaction attempts suspected digital fraud, the lowest of the African countries analysed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data-centre capacity is where the year's building actually happened. The state facility went from **built but neither certified nor launched to in operation**, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, with critical government services **migrated onto it** though no confirmation is on file that the mid-2026 initial phase completed. The commercial facility went from **a first module under commissioning with generators en route and no revenue**, to fully commissioned at **proof-of-concept revenue**, its on-site gas generation now **supplemented by solar**.

Two cross-border items advanced from nothing to paper. A **memorandum covering cross-border fibre interconnection, capacity exchange and IP transit** was signed with no build, cost or date; a **solar data-centre campus at Palapye** has had nothing on file since October 2025. The one physical delivery is the **first phase of a regional fibre corridor, live at 800Gbps**, whose live section is inside Zimbabwe.

Two measures did not move at all, and both matter. **International internet traffic** stands where it did in February 2025 at **just over 100Gbps**, the only national capacity figure the base holds; and the **P100m gateway upgrade completed in April 2025 has had no successor investment**.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
SADC Agricultural Information Management System	BASELINE NOT HELD	Existing agricultural systems being assessed for integration; no integration date or committed systems held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
SADC cross-border DPI and federated eKYC framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Botswana named as one of sixteen participating states; no Botswana-specific integration step, pilot or date held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronic Identification System	Prioritised for FY2025/26 as a partnership, not progressed	Rescoped to integrate digital identity, a national wallet and e-government services; a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 in FY2026/27	STALLED, RESCOPED
Omang card production and replacement	Replacement operating without reported delay	Delays running since the start of 2026; no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment	REGRESSED
Mandatory SIM registration	Mandatory for all users (2024-03)	Unchanged; no later regulator statement, registration rate or de-registration figure held	NO CHANGE
National Public Key Infrastructure	BASELINE NOT HELD	P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National Registration (Amendment) Act 2025	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force; service providers reported to be refusing even the replacement receipt	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Instant cross-border payment corridor into Botswana	No live regional instant corridor into Botswana	Live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe	ADVANCED
Mukuru Companion Card	Did not exist	A Visa-branded card issued against a remittance operator's wallet balance, adding ATM withdrawal, in-store payment and domestic online payment to a wallet that previously carried transfer and cash-out only; no separate bank account is required, it works across every mobile network in the country, each transaction is PIN-protected with 3D Secure on online purchases, and a lost card can be blocked from the handset. The operator puts the gap it addresses at 38 per cent of adults unbanked against mobile penetration of 164 per cent, or about 4.22 million connections	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED
Biometric grant payment cards	More than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops (2025-05)	The same figure; no update in the twelve months	NO CHANGE
Citizen Wallet	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced as a unified wallet for subsidy delivery alongside a cryptographic card; no build, pilot, budget line or date since	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National payment switch	BASELINE NOT HELD	Funded in plan only; no build, procurement, operator or date on the record	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Taxi cashless payment and financing partnership	Not held	A commercial bank and the Yellow Light Taxi Association launched card acceptance on the bank's mobile tap product for taxi operators, with access to business loans of up to P60,000 conditioned on a formal banking history built through it	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronic voter registration	No priced voter-register line in any held document	P50,000,000 appropriated within the commission's development budget, with government committing in Parliament to an electoral-reform package built on one-time voter registration, the national identity card and a verified electronic voters' roll accessible to political parties	ADVANCED
Deeds registry processing	Substantially manual; workload 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year since the 2017-18 land Acts, with no added resources	Unchanged; no digitisation programme, budget line or date on the record	NO CHANGE
Elections Management System	BASELINE NOT HELD	Built and in testing, replacing platforms developed in the 1990s; no supplier, cost or acceptance date held	Baseline not held
Mandatory SMME registration and national database	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed only; no instrument, no penalties intended and no database in build	Baseline not held

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Animal Disease Surveillance Dashboard	Did not exist	In operation, consolidating field data for national animal-health surveillance	ADVANCED
Government Accounting and Budgeting System	Fully operational after the December 2024 fix, more than 20,000 users	Unchanged; no later statement, availability figure or upgrade held	NO CHANGE
Labour Market Information System	BASELINE NOT HELD	Near completion; no go-live date, cost or supplier held	Baseline not held

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
1Gov-1Citizen platform	33 e-services	52 e-services, including teacher registration, appointment scheduling and business facilitation	ADVANCED
E-Payslip portal	Did not exist	Offline with no reopening date; a privacy notice, an impact assessment, multi-factor authentication and disaster recovery added	REGRESSED
National e-Procurement System	Strategy approved 2025-06-17, no system operating	The same target date; the authority still states it has no real-time data on procurement transactions	NO CHANGE
Mandatory electronic invoicing	BASELINE NOT HELD	Provided for; no start date, threshold or scope published	Baseline not held

Identity moved backwards on two measures and sideways on a third. Card replacement went from [operating without reported delay to delays running since the start of 2026](#), with no backlog figure or restoration date. The electronic identification system went from [prioritised for FY2025/26 as a public-private partnership and not progressed, to rescope](#)d, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 in FY2026/27. Behind both, the public key infrastructure entered the record for the first time as [funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational](#).

Service delivery advanced on count and not on use: [e-services went from 33 to 52](#), with no usage figure at either end, while the [payroll portal was taken offline by the data-protection regulator](#) — the only Botswana government system the base records as suspended that way.

Two things acquired a price for the first time. The voter register went from [no priced line in any held document](#) to [P50,000,000 appropriated for FY2026/27](#) within the commission's P336,870,640 development budget, and a [cross-border instant payment corridor](#) went live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe.

Four positions held exactly still: the [e-procurement system's beginning-of-2027 target](#), the [deeds registry's substantially manual processing](#), the [biometric grant cards at more than 75,000 beneficiaries](#), and [BOTSAT-1's commercialisation](#), still stated as the next phase with no product, customer or revenue.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AI adoption, chatbot visits per internet user	BASELINE NOT HELD	0 to 0.40 visits per user per month on a 0 to 2.6 scale, among the lowest adopters, in a band covering about 45% of Africa	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Judicial capability on AI and digital evidence	BASELINE NOT HELD	A commitment stated; no programme, budget, date or filing rollout on record	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
BoFiNet, the state wholesale network operator	Baseline not held	Wholly government-owned and regulated by the communications authority, operating the national fibre backbone, managing access to three international submarine systems — EASSy, WACS and Equiano — and selling leased lines, IP transit, metro Ethernet and cross-border regional connectivity. Its first integrated report puts revenue for the year ended 31 March 2025 at P376m against P485m the year before, alongside 71% national broadband penetration, 206 villages connected to the national fibre backbone, 17,586 homes covered with fibre-to-the-home, 1,272 public Wi-Fi premises, and a fifth consecutive year of profitability without government subvention, which it states makes it one of only five profitable state-owned enterprises in the country. Two material risks were escalated to its board: the structural disruption posed by low-earth-orbit satellite operators, and liquidity pressure from declining wholesale revenues	ADVANCED, REVENUE REGRESSED
BTCL profit before tax	P266.6m for the year ended 2025-03-31, on revenue of P1.49bn	P146.2m, down 45%, on revenue of P1.47bn, down 1.6%	REGRESSED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Research projects funded under the National Research Agenda	45 projects approved in 2024, all carried forward	45 projects, with no new projects added in FY2025/26	NO CHANGE

Nothing in Botswana's AI position moved, because there is nothing to move: no national policy, strategy or regulatory instrument is held at either end of the window. What entered the record is one commitment — the [Judiciary's resolution to train judges in AI](#) — and one external measure of adoption.

The sector's measurable positions both regressed or stalled. The listed operator's **profit before tax fell 45% to P146.2m on revenue down 1.6% to P1.47bn**, on company-reported figures. Research activity is unchanged for a second year: **45 projects carried forward, five completed and none added**.

The one clear advance is diplomatic: Botswana went from **not a signatory to the 68th signatory of the Artemis Accords**.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulator school ICT and cyber-awareness training	BASELINE NOT HELD	Four schools reached; no national coverage figure	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ITU and CRASA geographic-information training	BASELINE NOT HELD	Regulators from Botswana, Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe attending, under the Africa Broadband Maps project	<i>Baseline not held</i>
STEAM e-learning, coding and robotics programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	P654.4m awarded; the financial evaluation was received, adjudicated and approved the same day, and the decision published 2026-07-08	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Research Agenda	45 projects approved in 2024; the agenda approved by Cabinet July 2025	45 projects carried forward, P9.5m spent in FY2025/26, five completed and none added	ADVANCED, NO NEW PROJECTS ADDED
University of Botswana virtual-reality programme	Did not exist	The first local virtual-reality programme, giving remote access to university laboratories	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mascom device-financing facility	Launched, no uptake figure published (2025-05)	Still no uptake, portfolio or default figure published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
BTC prepaid mobile data tariffs	BASELINE NOT HELD	1.5GB a day for P10; 4GB a month for P65; 30GB over 30 days for P199; 100GB over 30 days for P349	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
BTC Community Wi-Fi, Old Naledi	A single site, tariffs P2 to P10 plus a free 45-minute daily window (2025-06)	The same single site; no second site recorded to 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Universal Access and Service Fund school digital centres	BASELINE NOT HELD	P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each; no programme total or school target published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Access instruments did not move. [Community Wi-Fi is still the single site it was](#), and the [device-financing facility has published no uptake, portfolio or default figure](#) in the twelve months since launch.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Statistician General	The post held in an acting capacity	A substantive statistician general in post; data quality described by a named analyst as worryingly uneven	ADVANCED
Africa Broadband Maps training	BASELINE NOT HELD	Training under way with Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe; no Botswana broadband map published	Baseline not held
Second Statistics Development Strategy (2026-2030)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Launched, aligned to National Development Plan 12	Baseline not held

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
BOTSAT-1	In orbit, hyperspectral, with data commercialisation stated as the next phase	Unchanged; commercialisation still stated as the next phase, with no product, customer or revenue held	NO CHANGE

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Artemis Accords accession	Not a signatory	Signed as the 68th signatory, about fifteen months after the national satellite launch	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Chinese AI cooperation offer	Did not exist	China's ambassador publicly offered AI cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching Chinese AI technology as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 AI training places for developing countries and AI application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union	ADVANCED
Huawei ICT Academy in Botswana	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating with five tertiary institutions; certifications in cloud, networking, data management and cybersecurity	Baseline not held

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
EU Cooperation Facility for digital transformation	EUR 1,500,000 committed, US\$0 disbursed	EUR 1,500,000 committed, US\$0 disbursed at the record's access date	NO CHANGE

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Kala Data heads of agreement	Heads of agreement in place with the UAE counterparty, site planning under way	Unchanged; the UAE counterparty is not named in the operator's 2026-08-03 quarterly account	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	the strategy document itself, or a gazette notice or ministerial statement giving its date of adoption and version	not yet probed
National IPv6 transition plan	a regulator or ministry IPv6 transition plan with a target date, or a published IPv6 adoption percentage for Botswana	not yet probed
National open-data portal or policy	a named national open-data portal, a Cabinet-approved open-data policy, or a statistics-office dataset register with a publication date	not yet probed
EU-Botswana digital cooperation instrument since 2022	a named Global Gateway or development package for Botswana with a value and a signature date	not yet probed
Local-government digital systems	a local-government ministry committee-of-supply speech naming council systems, or a named council-level rates, licensing or land-allocation platform with a dated statement	not yet probed
National AI policy or strategy	a gazetted national AI policy, or the development plan's AI policy project producing a published document	not yet probed
India-Botswana technology or digital cooperation	any India-Botswana memorandum, line of credit, training record or Indian vendor contract naming Botswana	not yet probed
Official internet penetration figure	the regulator's annual report, or a statistics-office household ICT access survey	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure	a dated statistics-office or regulator household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate	not yet probed
Universal fund annual allocation and school target	the regulator's annual report, or the universal fund's own accounts	not yet probed
Audited outturn for digital budget lines	the Auditor General's report on the accounts of the Government of Botswana for FY2024/25 or FY2025/26	not yet probed

Eleven rows carry no position at either end. Four are instruments the state names without producing: no cybersecurity strategy, no AI policy or strategy, no IPv6 transition plan, no open-data portal or policy. Three are measures of the state's own delivery that nobody publishes: no official internet penetration figure — leaving a reference study and a regulator statement three weeks apart and unreconciled as the only readings — no national digital-literacy rate, and no universal-fund annual allocation or school target.

The remaining four are a whole layer and three relationships: nothing at all on district or council digital systems, no audited outturn for any digital budget line in any year, no named European Union instrument behind the assistance the minister described, and no India cooperation of any kind. The absence of an audited outturn is the one that bears hardest on this document, because every budget movement above is stated at appropriation stage. Each row is in `gaps.csv` with what would settle it; none has yet been probed on a date.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-26
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-progress.html
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.